

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1974 RECOMMENDATION CONCERNING EDUCATION FOR INTERNATIONAL UNDERSTANDING, CO-OPERATION AND PEACE AND EDUCATION RELATING TO HUMAN RIGHTS AND FUNDAMENTAL FREEDOMS

I. Introduction

A. About the 1974 Recommendation

1. UNESCO's *1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms*¹ (the "1974 Recommendation") aims to promote international education and world peace through understanding, solidarity and cooperation. It was adopted on 19 November 1974 by the General Conference of UNESCO at its 18th session.

2. The *1974 Recommendation* applies to formal, non-formal and informal education and to all levels, from pre-primary to tertiary and adult education and lifelong learning. The General Conference recommended "*that Member States should apply*" the provisions included in the *1974 Recommendation* "*by taking whatever legislative or other steps*" that provide institutional (e.g. policies and legal frameworks) and pedagogical (e.g. curricula, teacher training, educational materials, equipment, and student assessment) support for its implementation, based on the "*objectives*", referred to in paragraph 4 of the *1974 Recommendation*, "*regarded as major guiding principles of education policy*" including: an international dimension and a global perspective on education, cultural diversity, interdependence, communication, rights and responsibilities, international solidarity and cooperation, and problem solving.

3. Today, the principles of the *1974 Recommendation* apply equally well to Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) and to Global Citizenship Education (GCED) and therefore represent a powerful tool for promoting the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and in particular SDG Target 4.7 on the promotion of sustainable development and global citizenship through education, Target 12.8 on access to information on sustainable development and Target 13.3 on climate change education.

4. The General Conference in its 39th session recommended the use of the *1974 Recommendation* reporting process to support the implementation and monitoring of Target 4.7 of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (39 C/Resolution 79). The UNESCO Executive Board at its 209th session approved the use of the current guidelines for both the monitoring of the *1974 Recommendation* and the collection of data needed for the following global SDG indicator for which UNESCO is custodian (209 EX/Decision 18.II):

4.7.1, 12.8.1 and 13.3.1: *The extent to which (i) global citizenship education and (ii) education for sustainable development are mainstreamed in (a) national education policies; (b) curricula; (c) teacher education and (d) student assessment.*

5. Questions marked with an asterisk (*) will be used in the calculation of the respective indicators (**Table 1**). As approved by the Inter-Agency and Expert Group on the SDG Indicators, the indicators will be calculated for primary and secondary education only.

¹ http://portal.unesco.org/en/ev.php-URL_ID=13088&URL_DO=DO_TOPIC&URL_SECTION=201.html

Table 1 Questions used in the calculation of the global SDG indicator for Targets 4.7, 12.8 and 13.3

Policies	Curricula	Teacher education	Student assessment
A2, A4, A5, E1a	B2, B3, B4, E1b	C2, C3, C4, C5, E1c	D2, D3, E1d

B. Reporting obligations

6. The General Conference, at its 18th session, when adopting the *1974 Recommendation* recommended “*that Member States submit [...] reports concerning the action taken by them in pursuance of this recommendation*”. Moreover, in accordance with Article VIII of UNESCO’s Constitution “*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization [...] reports [...] on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4.*”

7. Thus, **all UNESCO Member States are expected to report on the steps they have taken to implement the 1974 Recommendation** preferably by completing the following questionnaire. Such reporting takes place every four years.

II. Guidelines for completion of the questionnaire

8. This questionnaire and its accompanying guidelines are addressed to Ministers responsible for relations with UNESCO. The questionnaire is typically completed by Ministries of Education and other government authorities responsible for education. Responses should cover, as far as possible, education at all levels of government, including sub-national levels where applicable as well as education outside the government sector.

9. National respondents are encouraged to **consult widely** both within, across and beyond government, including with Ministries of Environment, with national human rights institutions, the education sector, civil society partners and others, as necessary, to gather the information needed to complete the questionnaire.

10. Responses to the seventh consultation should cover:

- (i) the time period 2017-2020;
- (ii) education at all levels of formal education from pre-primary to tertiary education as well as non-formal education;
- (iii) all levels of government that have responsibility for education within the country; and
- (iv) where possible, education outside the government sector.

11. To assist countries in responding to this questionnaire, UNESCO has developed the following set of global citizenship education and education for sustainable development themes. The list is based on a review of current common practices in many countries as well as a review of relevant literature. While the terms ESD and GCED may be used differently in some countries, the list of themes typically captures what are seen as key elements of Target 4.7. Please refer to the definitions of key terms in **Section III** before completing the questionnaire.

Global citizenship education and education for sustainable development

1. cultural diversity and tolerance
 - 1.1 international or intercultural understanding, solidarity and cooperation
 - 1.2 intercultural and interreligious dialogue
 - 1.3 local, national and/or global citizenship
2. gender equality education
 - 2.1 gender-based equal opportunities
 - 2.2 gender equality and justice
 - 2.3 gender roles, identity and stereotypes
3. human rights education
 - 3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status
 - 3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation
 - 3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)
4. peace and non-violence
 - 4.1 friendly relations among peoples and nations
 - 4.2 challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together, including others and preventing violent extremism
 - 4.3 preventing all forms of violence including bullying, verbal abuse and gender-based violence
5. climate change education
 - 5.1 mitigation
 - 5.2 adaptation
 - 5.3 impact reduction
 - 5.4 early warning
6. environmental sustainability
 - 6.1 caring for the planet, protecting nature
 - 6.2 environmental justice
 - 6.3 biodiversity, water
7. human survival and well-being
 - 7.1 environmental health as it pertains to human well-being, disaster risk reduction
 - 7.2 health of the planet for future generations
 - 7.3 sustainable cities and communities
8. sustainable consumption and production
 - 8.1 responsible and sustainable lifestyles
 - 8.2 green economy, green jobs
 - 8.3 sustainable energy

III. Definitions of key terms

Term	Definition
Themes of global citizenship and education for sustainable development	
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	<i>Education about and for diversity including language, ethnicity, race, religion as well as the development of tolerance, mutual respect and appreciation for cultural diversity. It includes intercultural and interreligious dialogue, understanding, solidarity and co-operation, and citizenship education.</i>
2. Gender equality education	<i>Education that addresses the wider issue of gender equality by promoting new attitudes and patterns of belief, transforming the way people think about traditional gender roles and helping to build long-term sustainable change. It examines how gender roles, activities, needs, opportunities, rights and entitlements affect men, women, girls and boys differently. It deals with the relationships between females and males, their access to and control of resources and the constraints they face relative to each other. It respects the rights of all learners – women, men, boys and girls – equally and gives equal access to learning opportunities, resources and protections. All learners benefit from and are treated in education equally without the limitations set by stereotypes, rigid gender roles and prejudices. It covers gender-based equal opportunities, gender equality and justice, and gender roles, identity and stereotypes.</i>
3. Human rights education	<i>Education that promotes universal respect for and observance of all human rights and fundamental freedoms and thus contributes, inter alia, to the prevention of human rights violations and abuses by providing persons with knowledge, skills and understanding and developing their attitudes and behaviours, to empower them to contribute to the building and promotion of a universal culture of human rights.</i> <i>It includes equality and non-discrimination, human rights values, dignity, justice, inclusion and participation and respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms.</i>
4. Peace and non-violence	<i>Education about peace and peace-building, mediation, conflict prevention and resolution, non-violence, reconciliation and living together peacefully. It includes advocating for friendly relations among peoples and nations, challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together and preventing violent extremism and other forms of violence including bullying.</i>
5. Climate change education	<i>Education to help people, in particular youth, understand, address, mitigate, and adapt to the impacts of climate change. It encourages changes in attitudes and behaviours needed to put the world on a</i>

	<i>more sustainable development path, and build a new generation of climate change-aware citizens.</i> <i>It covers various responses to climate change including mitigation, adaptation, impact reduction and early warning.</i>
6. Environmental sustainability	<i>Education about responsible interactions with the environment to avoid depletion or degradation and to promote environmental quality and health. It includes, caring for the planet and protecting nature, environmental justice, biodiversity and water.</i>
7. Human survival and well-being	<i>Education that promotes social well-being and harmony including in future generations due to healthy environmental systems. It includes health of the planet and environment related to human well-being, disaster risk reduction and sustainable cities and communities.</i>
8. Sustainable consumption and production	<i>Education on the use and production of resources, products and services that have a minimal adverse impact on the environment. It promotes resource and energy efficiency, sustainable infrastructure and green jobs. It includes responsible and sustainable lifestyles, the green economy and sustainable energy.</i>
Dimensions of learning	
Knowledge	<i>Factual information and understanding acquired through study and/or experience.</i>
Skills	<i>The ability to carry out a task well as a result of training, practice and innate aptitude. Skills may be physical, mental or both.</i>
Values	<i>Principles that form the foundation on which individuals conduct themselves and interact with others and with the environment around them.</i>
Attitudes and behaviours	<i>Ability to act on the basis of beliefs and knowledge acquired through study or experience.</i>
Levels of education	
Pre-primary	<i>Education designed to support children's early cognitive, physical, social and emotional development and introduce young children to organized instruction outside of the family context. Participants are usually aged from three years.</i>
Primary and secondary	<i>Education designed to:</i> <i>(i) provide students with fundamental skills in reading, writing and mathematics (i.e. literacy and numeracy) and establish a solid foundation for learning and understanding core areas of knowledge and personal development (primary education); and</i> <i>(ii) prepare students for further education at post-secondary and tertiary levels and for entry into the labour market (secondary education).</i> <i>It includes both general and vocational education.</i>

Tertiary	<i>Education designed to provide learning activities in specialised fields of education. It aims at learning at a high level of complexity and specialisation. It includes both what is commonly understood as academic education and advanced vocational or professional education.</i>
Types of education	
Adult education	<i>Education specifically targeted at individuals who are regarded as adults by their society to improve their technical or professional qualifications, further develop their abilities, enrich their knowledge with the purpose to complete a level of formal education, or to acquire, refresh or update their knowledge, skills and competencies in a particular field.</i>
Formal education	<i>Education that is institutionalized, intentional and planned through public organizations and recognized private bodies which – in their totality – constitute the formal education system of a country. Formal education programmes are recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities. Formal education consists mostly of initial education (e.g., pre-primary, primary, secondary and tertiary education).</i>
Non-formal education	<i>Education that is an addition, alternative and/or a complement to formal education within the process of the lifelong learning of individuals. It is often provided to guarantee the right of access to education for all. It caters to people of all ages but does not necessarily apply a continuous pathway-structure. It may be short in duration and/or low-intensity, and it is typically provided in the form of short courses, workshops or seminars. Non-formal education mostly leads to qualifications that are not recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities or to no qualifications at all. Non-formal education includes programmes on life skills including literacy and numeracy, work skills, and social or cultural development. Most types of adult education are also included.</i>
Vocational education	<i>Education that is designed for learners to acquire the knowledge, skills and competencies specific to a particular occupation or trade or class of occupations or trades. Vocational education may have work-based components (e.g. apprenticeships). Successful completion of such programmes leads to labour-market relevant vocational qualifications acknowledged as occupationally-oriented by the relevant national authorities and/or the labour market. Vocational education can be offered at secondary and post-secondary or tertiary levels of education.</i>

IV. Information about the respondent

Country:

Estonia

Organization:

Estonian Ministry of Education and Research

Date of submission:

01.02.2021

V. Other contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire

Please indicate below the names of other organizations and contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire.

Government institutions including other Ministries (please specify):

Ministry of the Interior of Estonia

National human rights institutions (please specify):

Local and regional authorities responsible for education (please specify):

Other local and regional authorities (please specify):

Organizations representing education stakeholders (e.g. teachers, students, parents, etc.) (please specify):

Other civil society organizations (please specify):

Others (please specify):

VI. Questionnaire

A. Laws and policies (preamble and paras 4 and 7 of the 1974 Recommendation)

A1a. Please describe any specific national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal framework(s) in your country that govern the promotion of global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes² are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

Estonia does not have an official body for the implementation of ESD or GCED. However, ESD is part of the tasks of the Ministry of Education and Research, the Ministry of the Environment, the Ministry of the Foreign Affairs, the Ministry of the Social Affairs, and the commission for sustainable development on the governmental level. The Ministry of Education and Research and The Ministry of the Environment have appointed a national focal point to deal with the ESD. The Estonian National Commission for UNESCO has appointed in the council the national contact person for ESD.

Currently, Estonian Educational reforms are based on the Estonian Lifelong Learning Strategy 2020.

The Estonian national curricula support the implementation of the ESD and the GCED at all levels and in all subjects. The key themes of the SD, GC and competences are addressed explicitly in the National curriculum at various levels of formal education.

To improve the ESD at the tertiary education level, various programmes are carried out in the context of Estonian Lifelong Learning Strategy 2020, at professional higher education institutions and universities, ESD themes are in place in vocational education curricula, as well as in national and schools' curricula.

Estonia, through the Youth Field Development Plan, supports a network of school boards and youth councils, providing training and resources – a guidance handbook for teachers is currently in the piloting phase prior to publication to support this.

Many Higher and Vocational Education institutions consider sustainable development as a wide-ranging issue covering all their activities and they have visions, action plans, as well as study programmes. Universities are putting more and more effort to rise the environmental and ESD awareness through different projects and their own curricula.

Addressing ESD (a) for the master's level, (b) for the doctorate level:

(a) Tallinn University: School of Natural Sciences and Health; School of Educational Sciences; School of Humanities etc; Tallinn University of Technology (TalTech): Faculty of Science etc; The Estonian University of Life Sciences: Institute of Agricultural and Environmental Sciences, Institute of Forestry and Rural Engineering, etc.

(b) Tartu University: Faculty of Science and Technology, Faculty of Social Sciences etc; Tallinn University: School of Natural Sciences and Health; School of Educational Sciences; School of Humanities etc; Tallinn Technical University: Faculty of Chemical and Materials Technology, Faculty of Science etc; The Estonian University of Life Sciences: Institute of Agricultural and Environmental Sciences, Institute of Forestry and Rural Engineering,

Estonian non-governmental environmental organizations or non-profit organizations are working to raise public awareness and spread information about SD. These organizations, that also include hobby schools, mostly unite adults with a common interest in a particular subject.

² See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

GCED: [Basic Schools and Upper Secondary Schools Act](#): § 3. Fundamental values of general education schools subsection 3: The socialisation of the new generation is based on the traditions of Estonian culture, common European values, and the recognition of the main achievements of world culture and research. People who have acquired general education are able to integrate into society and contribute to the **sustainable social, cultural, economic and ecologic development of Estonian society**.

§ 5. Functions of upper secondary schools subsection 1: Upper secondary schools have both educating as well as edifying functions. The function of upper secondary schools is to prepare young people to act as creative, versatile, socially mature and trustworthy personalities who are conscious of their goals and objectives and able to attain them in various fields of life: as partners in their personal life, carriers and upholders of culture, in various occupations and roles in the labour market, and as **citizens responsible for the sustainability of society and the natural environment**.

National curriculum for basic schools and National curriculum for secondary schools: Civics and citizenship education, 30 academic hours in the II stage of study + 70 academic hours in the III stage + 70 academic hours in upper secondary school.

[Vocational Educational Institutions Act](#) § 3. Functions and obligations upon organisation of vocational training defines the purpose of vocational training: to create the possibilities for the formation of such individuals who possess the knowledge, skills and attitudes or competencies, and the experience and social readiness for working, participating in social life and for lifelong learning. In order to achieve the given purpose, the school shall perform the following main functions:

- 1) support the acquisition of competencies necessary for self-realisation and development, civil activity, social involvement, continuing education and employment (hereinafter key competencies) in order to enable the learner to manage successfully in the changing learning, physical and social and working environment;
- 2) support the formation of the student's vocational, professional and occupational competence in order to enable the student to perform successfully in the labour market;
- 3) develop and support the student's motivation for participation in lifelong learning etc.

The Standard of Vocational Education defines the learning outcomes of vocational training, including the structure and volume of key competencies in all levels.

The general studies modules determine the common learning outcomes in study in key competences for all vocational secondary education curricula, sustainable development topics included in environmental studies module and some learning outcomes embedded in others, for example sustainable consumption topics in mathematics. The volume of the vocational secondary education curriculum is 180 credit points and includes at least 60 credit points in studies in key competences. The vocational secondary education core studies modules have at least 30 credit points of integrated key competences study and their selection corresponding to the profile is set forth in the relevant national curriculum. The volume of general studies modules is 30 credit points, their content, volume, learning outcomes and assessment criteria at threshold level shall be set forth in the national curriculum.

A1b. Please provide the full names of any laws, legislation or legal frameworks referred to in A1a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

Please specify and list any major document(s).

- **Estonian “Lifelong Learning Strategy 2020”**
http://www.hm.ee/sites/default/files/estonian_lifelong_strategy.pdf (created by the MoER and approved by the Parliament 2014). The strategy guides the most important developments in the area of education, including sustainability
- The Estonian Research and Development and Innovation Strategy „**Knowledge-based Estonia 2014-2020**“ http://www.hm.ee/sites/default/files/estonian_rdi_strategy_2014-2020_en.doc (approved by the Parliament 2014). Strategy focuses on sustainable development of the society by means of research and development, and innovation. It contributes to achievement of the goals of Estonia’s long-term development strategy “Sustainable Estonia 21” as well as the Lisbon Strategy (the strategy for growth and jobs).
- **National curriculum for preschool child care institutions:** 29.05.2008 No 87, Riigi Teataja RT I 2008,23,152 (Koolieelse lasteasutuse riiklik õppekava)
https://www.hm.ee/sites/default/files/estonian_national_curriculum_for_preschool_child_care_institutions.pdf
- **The Estonian National Curriculum for Basic Schools** (approved by the Government in 2014) <https://www.hm.ee/en/national-curricula-2014>
- **The Estonian National Curriculum for Gymnasiums** (approved by the Government in 2014) <https://www.hm.ee/en/national-curricula-2014>
- **Youth Field Development Plan for 2014 -- 2020**
https://www.hm.ee/sites/default/files/nak_eng.pdf
- **Welfare Development Plan 2016–2023** https://www.sm.ee/sites/default/files/content-editors/eesmargid_ja_tegevused/welfare_development_plan_2016-2023.pdf
- **Estonian Environmental Strategy 2030** (approved by the Parliament 2007) available in Estonian: https://www.envir.ee/sites/default/files/keskkonnastrateegia_inglisek.
- **Climate Change Adaptation Development Plan until 2030**
https://www.envir.ee/sites/default/files/national_adaptation_strategy.pdf
- Basic Schools and Upper Secondary Schools Act
<https://www.riigiteataja.ee/en/eli/530062020003/consolide>
- Vocational Educational Institutions Act
<https://www.riigiteataja.ee/en/eli/ee/517072020005/consolide/current>
- Standard of Vocational Education
<https://www.riigiteataja.ee/en/eli/515012020003/consolide>

*A2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal frameworks on education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	National				Sub-national			
	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1	99	99	99	99
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1	99	99	99	99
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1	99	99	99	99
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1	99	99	99	99
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1	99	99	99	99
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1	99	99	99	99
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1	99	99	99	99
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1	99	99	99	99

A3a. Please describe any specific current national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives in your country that promote global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes³ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

In March 2017, the Minister of Education and Research (MoER) and the Minister of the Environment (MoE) signed a **Joint Action Memorandum**, the aim of which is to modernize education so that everyone can acquire the knowledge, skills, values and attitudes that contribute to sustainable development. The priorities of the Memorandum are based on the UN's Sustainable Development Goals 2030 and the UNESCO Global Action Program for Education for Sustainable Development (ESD).

In October 2018, the Minister of Education and Research and the Minister of the Environment signed **the action plan 2019-2022 for implementation of the Environmental education and awareness** (including ESD).

At the central government level, the implementation and monitoring of sustainable development issues is coordinated by the Government Office Strategy Unit, which also

³ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

coordinates Estonian competitiveness strategy Estonia 2020 and drafts and monitors the Government Action Plan. This helps to maintain the coherence between main horizontal strategies. To improve the efficiency in implementing the Strategy on Sustainable Development, **an inter-ministerial working group** for sustainable development was created already in 2008. The working group is headed by the Strategy Director and the members of the working group are representatives of ministries concerned with the implementation of the strategy (the Ministry of the Environment, the Ministry of Economic Affairs and Communications, the Ministry of Agriculture, the Ministry of Social Affairs, the Ministry of Education and Research, the Ministry of Culture, the Ministry of Finance, the Ministry of the Interior, the Ministry of Justice) at the level of deputy secretary generals and heads of department, as well as representatives of Statistics Estonia.

The Estonian national sustainable development strategy is implemented by governments' sectoral and thematic strategies and action plans. This constitutes as a strategy for developing the Estonian state and society until 2030. The strategy was completed in close cooperation between the experts and the stakeholders.

The Sustainable Development Act was adopted by Parliament already in 1995. In 2005, the Parliament adopted the Estonian Sustainable Development Strategy „Sustainable Estonia 21“, which states 4 main goals for sustainable development in Estonia: 1) Viability of Estonian cultural space; 2) Growth of welfare; 3) Coherent society; 4) Ecological balance. The strategy “Sustainable Estonia 21” is the main horizontal strategies that has to be taken into account by designing governments' strategic development plans also educational strategies.

The focus is on accessibility of quality education and opportunities to participate in lifelong learning. The Estonian SD strategy emphasises that the system of education and training is the foundation of economic development: education is the prerequisite of well-being. In the past decade, the share of early school leavers has decreased.

Both the National curriculum for basic school and the National curriculum for upper secondary schools describe 8 general competences. General competences are shaped through all subjects as well as in extracurricular and out-of-school activity and their development is monitored and directed by teachers as well as in cooperation between school and home. One of the general competence is social and civic competence - the ability to fulfil oneself; to act as an active, informed, helpful and responsible citizen and to support the democratic development of society; know and follow societal values and norms; to respect the rules of different environments and social diversity, the particularities of religions and nationalities; to cooperate with other people in different situations; accept the differences between people and their values and take them into account when communicating.

Basic Schools and Upper Secondary Schools Act: §3 subsection 2 mentions the values arising from the ethical principles specified in the Constitution of the Republic of Estonia, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the Convention on the Rights of the Child and the fundamental documents of the European Union are considered important.

A3b. Please provide the full names of any education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives referred to in A3a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

- **The Joint Action Memorandum for EE and ESD** signed by the Minister of Education and Research (MoER) and the Minister of the Environment (MoE) in 2017.
https://www.envir.ee/sites/default/files/uhiste_tegevuste_memorandum_31.marts_2017_0.pdf
(in Estonian language)
- **The action plan 2019-2022 for implementation of the Environmental education and awareness** (including ESD) signed by the Minister of Education and Research (MoER) and

the Minister of the Environment (MoE) in 2018.

https://www.envir.ee/sites/default/files/keskkonnahariduse_teadlikkuse_tegevuskava_2019-2022.pdf (in Estonian language).

- The Estonian National Strategy on Sustainable Development “**Sustainable Estonia 21**” (approved by the Parliament 2005) https://riigikantselei.ee/sites/default/files/content-editors/Failid/estonia_sds_2005.pdf covers many areas, which different ministries are responsible for. This constitutes as a strategy for developing the Estonian state and society until 2030. The strategy was completed in close cooperation between the experts and the stakeholders.
- National curriculum for basic school: <https://www.riigiteataja.ee/en/eli/ee/VV/reg/524092014014/consolide>
- National curriculum for upper secondary school: <https://www.riigiteataja.ee/en/eli/ee/VV/reg/524092014009/consolide>

*A4. Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives affecting each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

*A5 Please indicate whether national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives on education provide a mandate to integrate GCED and ESD in the following areas by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (*e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education*)

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
Design or revision of the curricula	1	1	1	1
Setting of programme learning objectives	1	1	1	1
Textbook development	1	1	1	1
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	1
Assessment of student outcomes	1	1	1	1
Sub-national				
Design or revision of the curricula	99	99	99	99
Setting of programme learning objectives	99	99	99	99
Textbook development	99	99	99	99
Teacher education and training	99	99	99	99
Assessment of student outcomes	99	99	99	99

B. Curriculum (paras 4 and 10-19 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

B1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in school curricula. Indicate whether topics are taught as standalone subjects or are integrated into the curricula of other subjects. Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes⁴ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

The key themes of SD and GC and competences are addressed explicitly in the National curriculum at various levels of formal education. The National Curriculums for basic schools and upper secondary schools (ISCED 1, 2, 3, 4 levels) includes a general part, subject syllabuses and topics that should be addressed in all subjects. The key themes of SD and GC (citizenship, peace, ethics, responsibility in local and global contexts, democracy and governance, justice, security, human rights, health, gender equity, cultural diversity, rural and urban development, economy, production and consumption patterns, corporate responsibility, environmental protection, natural resource management and biological and landscape diversity) are included in a general part and subject syllabuses of national curriculums. The ESD are taught in existing disciplines and there may be the special subjects for ESD at schools. The thematic emphasis differs according to age level. The relationship with life experiences and problems of a student are considered.

⁴ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

According to the National Curricula for Basic Schools and Upper Secondary Schools (2011, 2014) general competencies and a cross-curricular topics should be formed by all subject and class teachers through the whole learning process. The general competences are: 1) cultural and value competence; 2) social and citizen competence; 3) self-management competence; 4) learning to learn competence; 5) communication competence; 6) mathematics, natural sciences and technology competence; 7) entrepreneurship competence; 8) digital competence. The cross-curricular topics are: 1) lifelong learning and career planning; 2) environment and sustainable development; 3) civic initiative and entrepreneurship; 4) cultural identity; 5) information environment; 6) technology and innovation; 7) health and safety; 8) values and morals. They are presented as interdisciplinary approaches in curricula.

The cross-curricular topic “Environment and sustainable development” is presented in the National Curriculum already from 2002. Cross-curricular topics are a means of integrating general and subject field competences, subjects and subject fields and are taken into account in developing the school environment. The emphasis has been put on the interrelationship between natural, social and cultural environments, and on developing responsible attitudes to sustainable development. Opportunities for teaching ESD and GCED concepts are created for all subjects, including mathematics, physics, chemistry, local studies, geography and music.

All Estonian schools (primary, lower and upper-secondary education schools) have to prepare the school curriculum on the basis of the National Curriculum. The school curricula must specify how to implement the sustainable development topics, support the development of GCED competences, integrate the principles of sustainable development in everyday practices and lessons.

The curriculum is flexible enough to cope with differences at the local level and in individual schools. At the school level ESD education may be implemented through the structure of the learning environment, subject study and collaboration with regional institutions and enterprises, other educational and cultural.

Both the National curriculum for basic school and the National curriculum upper for secondary school describe 8 general competences. General competences are shaped through all subjects as well as in extracurricular and out-of-school activity and their development is monitored and directed by teachers as well as in cooperation between school and home. One of the general competence is social and civic competence - the ability to fulfill oneself; to act as an active, informed, helpful and responsible citizen and to support the democratic development of society; know and follow societal values and norms; to respect the rules of different environments and social diversity, the peculiarities of religions and nationalities; to cooperate with other people in different situations; accept the differences between people and their values and take them into account when communicating.

B1b. Please provide examples of curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

- [The Estonian National Curriculum for Basic Schools](#) (approved by the Government in 2014)
- [The Estonian National Curriculum for Upper Secondary schools](#) (approved by the Government in 2014)

*B2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

*B3 Please indicate in which subjects or fields of study GCED and ESD are taught in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Cultural diversity and tolerance	Gender equality	Human rights	Peace and non-violence	Climate change	Environmental sustainability	Human survival and well-being	Sustainable consumption and production
Arts	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Civics, civil or citizenship education	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Ethics/moral studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Geography	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Health, physical education and sports	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
History	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1

Language s	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Mathemat ics	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Religious education	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
Science	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Social studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Integrated studies	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
Other (please specify)								

*B4 Please indicate the approaches used to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	0
Cross-curriculum approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum</i>)	0
Integrated approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum</i>)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school</i>)	1

B5 Please indicate which human rights education themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre- primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
3. Human rights education				
3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status	1	1	1	1
3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation	1	1	1	1
3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)	1	1	1	1

C. Teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) (paras 4 and 33-37 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

C1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in initial training and in continuing professional development of teachers, trainers and educators. Indicate whether all teachers, trainers and educators or only some are required to receive training to teach GCED and/or ESD.

The initial teacher education equips teachers with competencies. Teachers of all levels are expected to achieve a subject or professional and didactical competency including the skills to create a secure environment of study and to develop the curriculum, to develop students' key competences (value competence, social competence, self-management competence, entrepreneurship competence, learning to learn competence, digital competence, communication competence, cultural awareness) and integrate the cross-curriculum topics (including values and morals and environment and sustainable development) in subject teaching.

With the support of EU Structural Funds the Ministry of Education and Research and Ministry of Environment have supplied educators with the competence to include sustainable development in their everyday teaching. The two main state universities which provide initial teacher's education prepared in-service programs and organise different ESD and GCED courses.

Initial training programmes may include GCED related compulsory subjects, e.g. study program "Teaching Humanities and Social Subjects in Basic School" in University of Tartu, "Teacher of history and civics" etc.

In the continuing professional development of teachers, several courses on civic education and/or human rights are offered, for instance by the Network of Estonian Nonprofit Organizations.

Schools have close cooperation with local environmental education centres and Environmental Investment Centre to promote environmental education at schools and teachers' competencies.

C1b. Please provide examples of teacher training policies or curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents. If possible, include examples related to initial training and to continuing professional development.

- Teacher of [history](#) and civics
- [Languages](#) and Multilingualism in School
- [Teaching Humanities and Social Subjects in Basic School](#)
- Examples of continuing professional development related to GCED:
<https://maailmakool.ee/koolitused-ja-tootoad/koolitused/>
https://www.humanrightsestonia.ee/inimoigusi_austav_kool/

*C2 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach GCED and ESD during initial or pre-service training and/or through continuing professional development. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Initial or pre-service training				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	1	1	1	1
Continuing professional development				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	Please refer to subsection I2.			

*C3 Please indicate on which GCED and ESD themes pre-service or in-service training is available for teachers, trainers, and educators at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

*C4 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach the following dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	1
Skills	1	1	1	1
Values	1	1	1	1
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	1

*C5 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to use the following approaches to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	1
Cross curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment, and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1

D. Student assessment (paras 4 and 5 of the 1974 Recommendation)

D1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are covered in student assessments and examinations. Indicate whether students are assessed only on their knowledge of and skills related to the topics being tested or also on their values, attitudes and/or behaviours.

The main aim of the national assessments of learning outcomes is to follow at national level how well the learning objectives have been reached as set in the National curricula. The quality assurance, national assessments of learning outcomes are done regularly. The implementation of cross-curricular themes has also been evaluated. The national tests are mostly carried out in years six and nine of basic education.

The national curriculum for preschool childcare institutions treats evaluation of children's development as cooperation between teachers and parents. Evaluation of a child's development is

important to understand the child's special qualities, determine his or her special needs and support his or her positive self-esteem and development as well as to plan teaching and learning in cooperation with parents.

Evaluation of a child's development is a part of the everyday process of teaching and learning. Teachers carry out observations according to a precise plan and children are being followed in everyday activities, free play situations and in activities guided by teachers. The basis for evaluation of a child's development is constituted by the presumed general skills and results in fields of teaching and learning. At least once per academic year, the teacher carries out a development process-oriented interview with the parent(s) regarding the development of the child, giving feedback on the child's development and study results and exploring the parent's views and expectations regarding the child's development. Pursuant to the Preschool Child Care Institutions Act, a preschool childcare institution shall issue a readiness for school card to those who have completed the preschool education curriculum, describing the results of development of the child. A parent submits the readiness for school card to the school where the child commences his or her compulsory school attendance.

In Estonia there are no standardized tests for ISCED 1 level. For finishing basic or lower secondary school students shall pass tree compulsory examinations and for finishing upper secondary school students have to pass 3 final state examinations, one school examination and compile a students' investigation. These school leaving examinations may cover key themes of SD, GC or cross-curriculum topics.

*D2 Please indicate whether the GCED and ESD themes below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	0
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	0
3. Human rights	1	1	1	0
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	0
5. Climate change	1	1	1	0
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	0
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	0
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	0

*D3 Please indicate which of the dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre- primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	0
Skills	1	1	1	0
Values	1	1	1	0
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	0

E. Mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment (paras 4-5, 7, 10-19 and 33-37 of the 1974 Recommendation)

*E1 Based on your responses to questions in the previous four sections (laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment) please indicate to what extent global citizenship education (GCED) and education for sustainable development (ESD) are mainstreamed⁵ in (a) education laws and policies, (b) curricula (c) teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) and (d) student assessment in your country. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell in the table below.

KEY:

0 Not at all	<i>GCED and ESD are not mainstreamed.</i>
1 Partially	<i>Some GCED and/or ESD themes⁶ are mainstreamed. Select this option if GCED is mainstreamed but ESD is not (or vice versa).</i>
2 Extensively	<i>Most GCED and ESD themes are mainstreamed.</i>
9 Not known	<i>It is not known whether GCED and ESD are mainstreamed or not.</i>
99 Not applicable	<i>The given level of government does not have responsibility for the given component (policies, curricula, teacher education or student assessment) and/or does not have responsibility for the given level or type of education. This may occur at the national level in federal countries where education is the responsibility of individual states or at the sub-national level in small countries where there is only one level of government.</i>

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
(a) Education laws and policies	1	1	1	9
(b) Curricula	1	2	1	0
(c) Teacher education	1	2	2	99
(d) Student assessment	1	1	1	99
Sub-national				
(a) Education laws and policies	99	99	99	99
(b) Curricula	99	99	99	99
(c) Teacher education	99	99	99	99
(d) Student assessment	99	99	99	99

⁵ GCED and ESD are mainstreamed if their themes are mentioned explicitly in relevant documents and are expected to be implemented by the relevant authorities (e.g. Ministries, regional or local education authorities), educational institutions (e.g. schools, colleges and universities) and/or education professionals (e.g. teachers, lecturers, trainers and educators) as appropriate.

⁶ Refer to the schema in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

F. Technical and vocational education and training (paras 25-29 of the 1974 *Recommendation*)

F1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in technical and vocational education and training. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

For the general (national) strategies, please refer to A3a.

The legislative basis for VET includes [Vocational Educational Institutions Act](#), [Standard of Vocational Education](#) and 21 different national curricula for upper secondary vocational education and training.

ESD

The content of VET curricula is based on professional standards or input from social partners and on key competences for lifelong learning (social and civic competence, self-definition, initiative, and entrepreneurship, learning competence, language competence, etc.). The operational indicators described in the professional standards for the different disciplines also cover the sustainable use of the environment and resources. For example, a learner in a chef's field of study must demonstrate the ability to use resources in a meaningful way and to guarantee the safety of the environment. Key competences have been integrated into basic studies in the curricula, including topics such as environmental sustainability and consumption and production, climate change and the natural world view.

The sustainability and rational use of resources in vocational training curricula has been prioritised by the initiative of [Edu ja Tegu](#) ("Success and Action") national programme of entrepreneurship education across educational levels. [The entrepreneurship competence model](#), underlying curriculum development, has "ethical and environmental resource sustainability" as a separate sub-competence that needs to be addressed in the curricula. As a learning outcome, it is expected that the vocational secondary education graduate understands that the principle of sustainability is paramount to the economy and entrepreneurship and is able to act as an informed and active citizen in the natural environment in compliance with the principles of environmental sustainability.

As an example of good practice, with the help of [Edu ja Tegu](#) programme, the implementation of student companies in vocational training has risen. Furthermore, services or products by the student companies could be gathered under the common keyword of "sustainable consumption and production".

While there are few innovative disciplines in the green economy yet, there are a number of VET-schools where environmental curricula are taught, such as The Luua Forestry School (forestry, horticulture and nature tourism) or the R pina School of Horticulture, which offers vocational qualification in the fields of horticulture, landscape gardening and construction, floristry and environment protection. R pina Horticulture School is also known for its [projects](#) promoting environmental education, where the target group covers mainly the general education students. Co-operation within the local community is also a priority for the school, which is also revealed by its slogan « Smart and close to nature ».

There is also a sustainable dimension within the national policies, as the state-owned VET-schools use energy labels, environmentally friendly waste management and in many schools, renewable energy is used for central heating, etc.

GCED

The national curriculum for vocational secondary education includes a module of social subjects on human rights, cultural diversity, gender equality, etc. As a learning outcome, the aim is, among others, that vocational secondary education graduates value universal values such as freedom, human dignity, equality etc. The graduates also understand how democratic social organisation works, how national and international conflicts might arise and finally, how to protect democracy by accepting differences. In 2020, the modules of secondary vocational secondary education about national defence were updated in cooperation with the Ministry of Defence, The Rescue Board, the Estonian Academy of Defence, the Defence Resources Board, and the National Defence Regiment. *National defence education and training*, a practical part of which includes 7-day defence camps, has also been extensively applied as a selective module in vocational schools. In addition, schools can apply for additional support from the Defence Resources Authority to organise the latter.

In order to ensure equal opportunities and to develop the competitiveness of vocational training graduates, the acquisition of Estonian language skills for students with a non-Estonian language background has been consistently supported during several ESF funding periods with additional language and cultural learning projects. Additional Estonian language learning was offered to students, a total of 1.2 million euros was allocated to schools in 2015-2020. A total of 1,800 students' language learning has been funded, teaching materials and schools have been prepared on the basis of the action plans submitted by vocational and higher education institutions by the end of 2019. Based on the statistics of the last three years, the level of Estonian language proficiency of secondary vocational school graduates with a different mother tongue is improving, but more than half of the graduates have yet to acquire the level of Estonian language proficiency needed for work. In 2019, 41.7% of students were proficient in Estonian language. The level of proficiency in Estonian varies from school to school, if in the 2018/2019 academic year, 85% of vocational secondary education graduates of Tallinn Service School passed the vocational secondary education in Estonian, the indicator was only 5% for the Ida-Virumaa Vocational Education Centre. The application of the required volume of Estonian language learning is most difficult in Ida-Virumaa and Tallinn. Further steps must be taken to increase the level of Estonian language proficiency of primary school graduates and support measures for further training of teachers in Estonian language education in addition to additional language learning for vocational learners.

G. Adult education (para 30 of the 1974 Recommendation)

- G1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in adult education and other forms of non-formal education including youth education, out-of-school education, etc. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

GCED

Citizenship education in the frame of adult education and non-formal education is largely part of civil society policy, which is coordinated by the Ministry of the Interior of Estonia. Initiatives for providing citizenship education as non-formal or adult education are diverse. There is no state-coordinated initiative for providing citizenship education for adults, however, a large part of civil

society and NGO initiatives are oriented to offering citizenship education through different formats. Such initiatives include, but are not limited to:

- *Kogukonnapraktika* (Community practice), through which students take part in a short internship at a non-profit organisation, involving school students, teachers, and NGOs. More than 48 schools and 250 NGOs take part in the program to involve nearly 1000 young participants annually. Students taking part of the programme choose an NGO, and during 10-15 hours, will participate in the NGOs activities and have an opportunity to learn about its structures, goals and learn about the non-profit sector as a whole. The initiative has been brought to life by the Network of Estonian Nonprofit Organizations, together with teachers. In 6 years, more than 50 schools with more than 3500 students combined have taken part of this programme.
- *Väärikate ülikool* is an initiative of the University of Tartu, which offers seminars and lectures for a public aged 50+/60+. The subjects covered during this course aim to educate its audience on social and current issues, and participants can obtain a certificate at the end of the course upon its completion. The initiative is supported by the Ministry of Education and Research, local governments, and private sector actors.
- A mechanism for supporting civil society actors, which in turn, favour the provision of citizenship education, is the National Foundation of Civil Society (NFCS), a state-financed civil society fund. The NFCS supports NGOs in their pursuit of developing different capacities, supporting over 100 projects and initiatives yearly, ranging from regional to international cooperation. The financed initiatives include projects aiming to raise knowledge and awareness on civil society and/or citizenship education.
- In 2020, the programme of the civil society for 2021-2024 was adopted. This programme aims to orient the development of the Estonian civil society, including certain aspects of the development of citizenship education.

ESD

Environmental education in the context of adult education and/or informal settings is coordinated by the Ministry of the Environment of Estonia. Environmental education is provided in concordance with the [the action plan 2019-2022 for implementation of the Environmental education and awareness](#), launched together by the Ministry of the Environment and the Ministry of Education and Research. Environmental education and awareness in informal settings is one of the three key fields of the strategy of the programme. In the time frame of 2017-2020, environmental education and awareness has been developed through different initiatives, including, but not limited to:

- Investing in environmental education through EU structural funds, aiming to [develop the infrastructure of environmental education](#), in the process of which 30 environmental education centres were either developed or renovated;
- [The environmental awareness programme of the Environmental Investment Centre](#) aims to support the development of environmentally friendly consumption habits by the Estonian people and an awareness of ecological balance. This programme includes four action lines which are supported:
 - Activities related to the implementation of an informal environmental management system (green office principle) aimed at the more environmentally friendly functioning of organisations, incl. educational institutions.
 - Activities supporting the development of environmentally friendly consumption habits in adults and families or learning about the ecological balance.

- Activities supporting the development of environmentally friendly consumption habits and learning about the ecological balance by students in the general educational system.
- Activities supporting the preparation of information materials for developing environmentally friendly consumption habits and explaining the ecological balance.
- The Ministry of the Environment has also held nature schools for journalists, aiming to inform the media of environmental matters by carrying out activities focused on both theoretical knowledge and practical skills.

In the field of youth education, the meeting of sustainable development goals is coordinated through the [youth field development plan](#).

H. Research and International Co-operation (paras 41-45 of the 1974 Recommendation)

H1 Please describe what kinds of research or experimentation have been carried out to improve the implementation of GCED and/or ESD. Describe briefly how the results of such activities have influenced education policies, curricula and/or teaching practices.

Many Higher Education Institutes consider sustainable development as a wide-ranging issue covering all their activities and they have their visions, action plans, as well as study programmes. The higher education institutions have embedded ESD in their own internal strategies.

For example: Tallinn University has joined the Green Academic Footprint initiative of the Network of Universities from the Capitals of Europe to participate in making the principles of sustainable development a part of everyday life. They work closely with opinion leaders, policy makers, communities, businesses and other universities to share green practices to reduce our ecological footprint.

H2 Please indicate which types of activities are available that promote international co-operation at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Hosting of international meetings on GCED and/or ESD	1	1	1	1
Participation in international meetings abroad on GCED and/or ESD	1	1	1	1
Support for programmes hosting foreign students, researchers and/or teachers	1	1	1	1
Membership of international networks including ASPnet	0	1	1	1

Joint research projects on GCED and/or ESD with foreign institutions	1	1	1	1
Other activities (please specify):				

I. Any other comments

- I1 Please indicate whether your country has faced any constraints, in particular related to global or national crises, including natural disasters, in implementing the 1974 Recommendation during the reporting period.

- I2 Please provide any other relevant information or clarifications regarding the implementation of the 1974 Recommendation or the mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in your country's education system.

Question C2 – the last row has intentionally been left blank, as participating in continuing professional development on GCED and ESD subjects is voluntary. There are several courses available through universities and non-governmental organisations, however, they are not mandatory.